

**FACULTY OF EDUCATION
UNIVERSITY OF BENIN, BENIN CITY**

SESSION: 2025/2026

COURSE CODE: EDU101

COURSE TITLE: INTRODUCTION TO TEACHING AND FOUNDATIONS OF
EDUCATION

Course Outline:

UNIT 1: TEACHING AS A PROFESSION

- (a) Definitions of profession
- (b) Characteristics of a Profession
- (c) The teaching Profession (Definitions and nobility)
- (d) Importance of the teaching Profession to national development
- (e) Challenges of the teaching Profession in Nigeria
- (f) Strategies to make teaching a noble profession

UNIT 2: TEACHERS' REGISTRATION COUNCIL OF NIGERIA (TRCN)

- (a) Act establishing the TRCN - Goals and Objectives
- (b) Roles of the TRCN
- (c) Career stages for teachers and school leaders
- (d) Ethics of the Teaching Profession

UNIT 3: THE TEACHER

- (a) Who is a teacher
- (b) Qualities of a teacher
- (c) Duties/roles of a Professional Teachers
- (d) Factors Responsible for Teachers Poor Image (Low Status, Poor Conditions of Service)

UNIT 4: THE TEACHING PROCESS

- (a) The Concept of teaching
- (b) The nature of teaching
- (c) Teaching as an act
- (d) Teaching as an enterprise
- (e) Teaching as an occupation
- (f) Other activities which resembles teaching: Instruction, conditioning, Indoctrination, training, drilling

UNIT 5: THE LEARNER AND LEARNING PROCESS

- (a) Understanding learners:
 - Slow Learners, -
 - Gifted/Talented Learners,
 - Normal/Average Learner,
 - Learners with disabilities

(b) THE LEARNING PROCESS:

- What is Learning
- Types of Learning
- Factors affecting Learning
- Motivating students to learn

UNIT 6: HISTORY OF EDUCATION IN NIGERIA

- (a) Traditional Education
- (b) Islamic Education
- (c) Christian Missionary Education
- (d) Modern (Western) Education
- (e) Post-Colonial Education System
 - The Phelps-stokes commission
 - The Ashby commission
 - Elliot Commission
- (f) The 6-3-3-4 and 9-3-4 Educational Policies

UNIT 7: NATIONAL POLICY ON EDUCATION

- (a) Philosophy and goals of education in Nigeria
- (b) The Universal Basic Education (UBE)
- (c) The Challenges of Implementing the UBE.
- (d) Post Basic Education
 - Rationale and Structure
 - Subject Offerings/streaming
 - The challenges of implementing the Post Basic Education

UNIT 8: CHILD AND ADOLESCENT DEVELOPMENT

- (a) Stages of Child development
- (b) Factors affecting Child development
- (c) Implications of Child Development for teaching and learning in the Nigerian School System
- (d) Stages of adolescent Development
- (e) Implication of adolescent developmental issues in education
- (f) Strategies for managing adolescent behavioral problems

UNIT 9: LEARNING THEORIES

- Behaviorist Learning Theory and implication
Pavlov, Skinner, Thorndike, Gagne
- Cognitive Learning Theory. Piaget, Bruner, Ausubel
- Socio cultural Learning Theory: Lev Vygotsky
- (NOTE: Briefly treat each learning theory and outline the education implications of each of them)

UNIT 10: HISTORICAL AND CURRENT DEVELOPMENTS IN PHILOSOPHY OF EDUCATION IN NIGERIA

- (a) What is Philosophy?
- (b) Functions of Philosophy
- (c) The Concept of Education
- (d) The Concept of Philosophy of Education
- (e) Justification/rationale for Philosophy of Education
(Don't teach the branches and Schools of thought in Philosophy: it is for EDU222)

Lecture Notes Prepared By Dr. Agnes Anuoluwapo Odia

UNIT 1: TEACHING AS A PROFESSION

A. Definitions of Profession

A profession is a type of occupation that requires specialized education, training, and expertise, and is often governed by a code of ethics or a professional body. Professionals are expected to apply their knowledge and skills in service to others, typically with a high degree of responsibility and integrity.

Concise definition:

A profession is a paid occupation that requires advanced education, specialized knowledge, and adherence to ethical standards.

B. Characteristics of A Profession

The key characteristics of a profession:

1. ***Specialized Knowledge and Expertise:*** A profession requires mastery of a specific body of knowledge, usually gained through advanced education and training.
2. ***Formal Education and Training:*** Entry into a profession typically requires completing a recognized program of study and obtaining relevant qualifications or licenses.
3. ***Standards and Code of Ethics:*** Professionals follow ethical guidelines and standards of practice to ensure integrity, responsibility, and accountability.
4. ***Autonomy in Decision-Making:*** Professionals exercise independent judgment and discretion in their work, based on their expertise.
5. ***Commitment to Service:*** A profession is often service-oriented, emphasizing responsibility to clients, society, or the public good.
6. ***Professional Association or Regulatory Body:*** Most professions are governed by an organization that maintains standards, enforces ethics, and advocates for the field.
7. ***Continuous Professional Development:*** Professionals are expected to stay updated with new knowledge, skills, and advancements through ongoing learning.
8. ***Recognition and Respect:*** Professions typically hold a high social status and are respected for their contribution to society.

C. The Teaching Profession (Definitions And Nobility)

Definition of the Teaching Profession:

The teaching profession is the specialized occupation of educating others, typically in formal settings such as schools, colleges, and universities. It involves the systematic delivery of knowledge, skills, values, and attitudes, guided by pedagogy, curriculum standards, and ethical responsibilities.

A teacher is a trained and certified professional whose role is to facilitate learning, inspire growth, and support the intellectual, emotional, and social development of students.

Key Elements of the Teaching Profession:

- (a) Specialized knowledge in subject matter and pedagogy
- (b) Formal training and certification
- (c) Adherence to ethical and professional standards
- (d) A commitment to lifelong learning
- (e) Service to society through education and empowerment

Nobility of the Teaching Profession:

The teaching profession is often referred to as a noble calling because of its profound impact on individuals and society. Teachers shape minds, build character, and influence the future, making their role essential in the development of educated, responsible, and compassionate citizens.

Why Teaching Is Considered Noble:

1. Nation-Building Role – Teachers help cultivate informed and responsible citizens.
2. Lifelong Impact – A good teacher's influence can last a lifetime.
3. Selfless Service – Teachers often go beyond duty to support students emotionally and academically.
4. Moral Leadership – Teachers model ethical behavior, empathy, and social values.
5. Empowerment Through Education – They break cycles of poverty, ignorance, and inequality by empowering learners.

“A teacher affects eternity; he can never tell where his influence stops.” – Henry Adams

D. Importance Of The Teaching Profession To National Development

The teaching profession plays a crucial role in national development, as it directly shapes the knowledge, skills, attitudes, and values of the population. No nation can progress

without a strong, well-educated citizenry—and teachers are the foundation of that education.

Key Reasons Why Teaching Is Vital to National Development:

1. ***Human Capital Development:*** Teachers equip students with the knowledge and skills needed for the workforce, driving economic growth and innovation.
2. ***Promotion of Civic Values and National Identity:*** Through subjects like social studies and history, teachers instill values such as patriotism, responsibility, and respect for the law.
3. ***Reduction of Illiteracy and Poverty:*** Education provided by teachers empowers individuals to access better economic opportunities and improve their quality of life.
4. ***Moral and Ethical Development:*** Teachers help mold character, promote integrity, and nurture future leaders who make ethical decisions for the good of society.
5. ***Social Cohesion and Equality:*** Teachers foster inclusive environments that promote respect for diversity, bridging gaps across ethnic, gender, and socioeconomic lines.
6. ***Innovation and Technological Advancement:*** Educators inspire creativity and curiosity, encouraging students to pursue science, technology, and research that fuel national progress.
7. ***Leadership Training and Nation-Building:*** Many national leaders, professionals, and change-makers were once shaped by dedicated teachers who nurtured their potential.

"Education is the most powerful weapon which you can use to change the world." – Nelson Mandela

In Summary, Teachers are not just instructors; they are nation-builders, shaping the intellectual and moral backbone of society. Investing in the teaching profession means investing in the future of a nation.

E. Challenges Of The Teaching Profession In Nigeria

The teaching profession in Nigeria faces numerous challenges that hinder its effectiveness and overall contribution to national development. These challenges impact teacher motivation, performance, and the quality of education delivered to learners. Key challenges facing the teaching profession in Nigeria:

1. **Poor Remuneration and Welfare:** Teachers, especially in public schools, are often underpaid and face delayed salaries, lack of housing, and inadequate retirement benefits.
2. **Inadequate Teacher Training and Professional Development:** Many teachers lack access to regular in-service training or modern teaching methods, leading to outdated and ineffective instructional practices.
3. **Overcrowded Classrooms:** Due to a shortage of teachers, many classrooms are overcrowded, making it difficult to provide individual attention and manage student behavior.
4. **Insufficient Teaching and Learning Materials:** Many schools lack textbooks, teaching aids, laboratories, libraries, and digital tools, making effective teaching difficult.
5. **Poor Infrastructure:** Many schools, especially in rural areas, operate in dilapidated buildings without basic facilities like electricity, water, or toilets.
6. **Low Social Status and Public Perception:** Teaching is often viewed as a low-status job, leading to low morale and discouraging talented individuals from entering or staying in the profession.
7. **Lack of Motivation and Recognition:** Teachers rarely receive awards, promotions, or recognition for their hard work, making it difficult to stay motivated.
8. **Political Interference and Poor Policy Implementation:** Inconsistent education policies, political favoritism in teacher recruitment, and poor implementation of reforms weaken the system.
9. **Security Challenges:** In some regions, especially the North-East, teachers and students face threats from insurgency, kidnapping, and violence, disrupting education.
10. **Brain Drain:** Many experienced teachers leave the profession or migrate abroad in search of better opportunities, leaving gaps in the education system.

In Summary, the teaching profession in Nigeria is challenged by poor funding, lack of support, and systemic issues that undermine its impact. Addressing these problems is essential to improving the quality of education and driving national development.

F. Strategies to Make Teaching a Noble Profession

To restore and uphold the nobility of the teaching profession, deliberate efforts must be made by governments, communities, and stakeholders in education. These strategies should aim to improve the status, motivation, and effectiveness of teachers while reinforcing their role as key agents of national development.

1. Improve Teachers' Welfare and Remuneration

- ❖ Offer competitive salaries and regular payment.
- ❖ Provide housing, healthcare, and retirement benefits.
- ❖ Introduce performance-based incentives and bonuses.

2. Professional Development and Training

- ❖ Organize regular in-service training and workshops.
- ❖ Encourage continuous learning through scholarships and study leaves.
- ❖ Update teacher education curricula to reflect modern pedagogy and technology.

3. Raise the Social Status of Teachers

- ❖ Launch public campaigns to celebrate and appreciate teachers.
- ❖ Establish national and state awards to recognize outstanding educators.
- ❖ Promote media representation of teachers as role models and nation-builders.

4. Strengthen Teacher Certification and Licensing

- ❖ Ensure that only qualified and certified individuals enter the profession.
- ❖ Empower regulatory bodies like the Teachers Registration Council of Nigeria (TRCN) to enforce standards.

5. Improve School Infrastructure and Teaching Resources

- ❖ Provide modern teaching aids, digital tools, libraries, and well-equipped classrooms.
- ❖ Ensure safe and conducive working environments, especially in rural and underserved areas

6. Promote Career Growth and Advancement

- ❖ Create clear career paths and leadership opportunities within the education system.
- ❖ Ensure fair and timely promotions based on merit and performance.

7. Involve Teachers in Policy Decisions

- ❖ Include teachers in curriculum development and education reform processes.
- ❖ Allow their voices to be heard through unions and professional associations.

8. Enforce Ethical Standards and Accountability

- ❖ Uphold discipline and professional ethics to maintain public trust.
- ❖ Sanction misconduct while promoting excellence.

In summary, making teaching a noble profession requires investment, respect, and recognition. When teachers are well-trained, well-paid, and valued, they are empowered to inspire students, uplift communities, and contribute meaningfully to national progress.

TOPIC 2: TEACHERS REGISTRATION COUNCIL OF NIGERIA (TRCN)

a. Acts Establishing TRCN – Goals and Objectives

The Teachers Registration Council of Nigeria (TRCN) was established by Decree 31 of 1993, now known as the TRCN Act, CAP T3, Laws of the Federation of Nigeria 2004. It is a regulatory agency under the Federal Ministry of Education, with the statutory mandate to regulate and control the teaching profession in Nigeria at all levels of the education system.

Goals and Objectives of TRCN

1. ***Professionalization of Teaching:*** TRCN was established to make teaching a fully professionalized field, comparable to other professions such as law, medicine, and engineering.
2. ***Registration and Licensing:*** To register and license qualified teachers, ensuring that only certified individuals are allowed to teach in Nigerian educational institutions.
3. ***Teacher Qualification Standards:*** TRCN sets and enforces minimum standards for teacher education, training, and practice.
4. ***Ethical Conduct and Discipline:*** The council promotes professional ethics and applies disciplinary actions to erring teachers.
5. ***Career Progression and Development:*** TRCN ensures a structured career path for teachers and promotes continuous professional development.
6. ***Promotion of Excellence in Teaching:*** By regulating entry into the profession and promoting training programs, TRCN aims to improve the quality of teaching and learning in Nigeria.
7. ***National Education Goals Alignment:*** To ensure that teacher quality aligns with national educational goals and international best practices.

b. Roles of TRCN

The Teachers Registration Council of Nigeria plays several pivotal roles in shaping and maintaining the standards of the teaching profession in Nigeria. These include:

1. Regulation and Control of the Teaching Profession

- ❖ Setting professional standards and ensuring compliance.
- ❖ Accrediting teacher education institutions and their programs.

2. Registration and Licensing

- ❖ Conducting teacher qualification exams (PQE).
- ❖ Registering qualified teachers and issuing licenses.

3. Development of Teacher Standards

- ❖ Defining the National Professional Standards for Teachers (NPST).
- ❖ Updating the teaching profession to match global education trends.

4. Professional Development

- ❖ Organizing workshops, seminars, and training programs.
- ❖ Supporting in-service training and teacher retraining initiatives.

5. Disciplinary Oversight

- ❖ Investigating cases of professional misconduct.
- ❖ Imposing sanctions such as suspension or revocation of teaching licenses.

6. Advocacy and Public Awareness

- ❖ Promoting the image and welfare of the teaching profession.
- ❖ Engaging with stakeholders to foster support for teacher development.

7. Research and Innovation

- ❖ Supporting research in education and pedagogy.
- ❖ Promoting innovations that enhance teaching effectiveness.

c. Career Stages for Teachers and School Leaders

TRCN recognizes a career structure that encourages professional growth and leadership in education. The career stages are structured to support advancement through certification, experience, and performance.

1. Career Stages for Teachers

TRCN's career stages for teachers align with the National Teacher Education Policy and include:

a. Beginning Teacher (BT)

- ❖ Newly qualified teachers with a teaching license.
- ❖ Engage in induction programs and mentoring.

b. Proficient Teacher (PT)

- ❖ Teachers with 3–5 years of successful teaching experience.
- ❖ Demonstrate effectiveness in pedagogy and classroom management.

c. *Highly Accomplished Teacher (HAT)*

- ❖ Experienced teachers who mentor junior colleagues.
- ❖ Exhibit leadership in instructional practices.

d. *Distinguished Teacher (DT)*

- ❖ Veteran educators with national/international recognition.
- ❖ Influence policy, lead innovation, and contribute to professional development at high levels.

2. Career Stages for School Leaders

School leaders (e.g., head teachers, principals) are also expected to follow structured career progression:

a. *Instructional Leader*

Focus on curriculum implementation and teaching support.

b. *Administrative Leader*

Handle school governance, staff management, and infrastructure.

c. *Strategic Leader*

Shape long-term goals, foster partnerships, and manage change.

TRCN promotes certification programs and leadership training to support school leaders at each of these stages.

d. *Ethics of the Teaching Profession*

Ethics in teaching refers to the professional code of conduct expected from teachers in their roles as educators, role models, and members of society. TRCN outlines a comprehensive Code of Ethics for Nigerian Teachers, which guides their behavior and responsibilities.

Core Ethical Principles include the following:

1. *Commitment to Learners*

- ❖ Uphold the rights and dignity of students.
- ❖ Provide equal learning opportunities without discrimination.
- ❖ Promote the intellectual, emotional, and social development of all learners.

2. Commitment to the Profession

- ❖ Maintain competence through continuous learning.
- ❖ Uphold professional integrity and avoid unethical behavior.
- ❖ Collaborate with colleagues and respect institutional hierarchy.

3. Commitment to Parents and the Community

- ❖ Respect the cultural and religious values of the community.
- ❖ Communicate effectively with parents and guardians.
- ❖ Act in the best interest of learners in and out of school.

4. Commitment to the Employer

- ❖ Perform duties diligently and faithfully.
- ❖ Respect school policies, rules, and the leadership structure.
- ❖ Avoid absenteeism, negligence, and insubordination.

5. Disciplinary Standards

Teachers found guilty of misconduct (e.g., sexual harassment, examination malpractice, corruption, or abuse) face disciplinary actions including suspension, license withdrawal, or criminal prosecution.

Examples of Unethical Conduct

- ❖ Examination malpractice
- ❖ Abuse of students (verbal, physical, or sexual)
- ❖ Absenteeism and dereliction of duty
- ❖ Conflict of interest in student evaluation
- ❖ Plagiarism in academic work.

UNIT 3: THE TEACHER

a. Who is a Teacher?

A teacher is a trained and knowledgeable individual who facilitates learning by guiding, instructing, and mentoring students in various educational settings. Teachers play a pivotal role in shaping minds, imparting knowledge, and developing skills and character among learners.

They work at different levels of education—from early childhood to tertiary institutions—and across various disciplines.

A teacher is not merely a transmitter of information but also a facilitator of critical thinking, creativity, and lifelong learning. They serve as role models, moral guides, and key contributors to the intellectual and social development of students and, by extension, the society at large.

b. Qualities of a Teacher

An effective teacher possesses a combination of intellectual, emotional, and interpersonal qualities. Some of the key qualities include:

1. ***Knowledgeable and Competent:*** A good teacher must have a strong grasp of their subject matter and keep up to date with developments in their field.
2. ***Communication Skills:*** The ability to convey ideas clearly and adapt explanations to different learning styles is essential.
3. ***Patience and Empathy:*** Teaching requires understanding individual student needs, especially in diverse or challenging classrooms.
4. ***Integrity and Professionalism:*** A teacher should model ethical behavior and respect both students and colleagues.
5. ***Adaptability and Creativity:*** The modern educational environment demands teachers who can innovate and adapt to new methods and technologies.
6. ***Passion and Dedication:*** A genuine interest in teaching and a commitment to student success greatly enhance teacher effectiveness.

7. **Classroom Management Skills:** The ability to create a conducive learning environment by maintaining order and encouraging positive behavior is critical.

c. Duties/Roles of a Professional Teacher

Professional teachers perform a wide range of duties that extend beyond classroom instruction. These include:

1. **Instructional Role:** Planning lessons, delivering instruction, assessing student understanding, and modifying teaching strategies accordingly.
2. **Mentorship and Guidance:** Supporting students' emotional and moral development, offering career and personal advice, and serving as role models.
3. **Curriculum Implementation:** Ensuring that learning objectives align with educational standards and adjusting content for relevance and student needs.
4. **Assessment and Evaluation:** Designing tests and assignments, grading student work, and providing constructive feedback.
5. **Administrative Tasks:** Maintaining records, attending staff meetings, and participating in school committees.
6. **Professional Development:** Continuously improving through training, workshops, and further education.
7. **Community Engagement:** Collaborating with parents, guardians, and community stakeholders to support student learning and school improvement.

d. Factors Responsible for Teacher's Poor Image

Despite their critical role, teachers often face a poor public image due to a variety of factors:

1. **Low Remuneration:** In many regions, teachers are poorly paid, which undermines their social status and perceived value.
2. **Lack of Professional Development:** Inadequate training opportunities lead to outdated practices and poor performance, reinforcing negative stereotypes.

3. **Political Interference:** Frequent policy changes and lack of autonomy reduce teachers' effectiveness and morale.
4. **Poor Working Conditions:** Overcrowded classrooms, insufficient resources, and lack of administrative support affect performance and perception.
5. **Negative Media Portrayals:** The media often highlights instances of misconduct or failure rather than successes, which skews public perception.
6. **Public Misunderstanding of the Profession:** Many underestimate the intellectual and emotional demands of teaching, viewing it as an "easy" job.
7. **Inconsistent Standards:** Lack of strict entry and professional standards in some regions allows unqualified individuals into the profession, diminishing its credibility.
8. **Student Behavior and Discipline Issues:** Growing disciplinary problems can hinder teaching and lead the public to blame teachers for systemic failures.

Factors Responsible For Teachers' Poor Self-Concept

Many factors are responsible for the low status of teachers. Some of them include:

- ❖ Lack of recognition of teachers by the various governments unlike the professionals such as medicine and law.
- ❖ Many teachers are not professionally trained
- ❖ Some teachers perform very poorly
- ❖ Many use teaching as a stepping stone to better jobs
- ❖ The level of professional training and intensity of professional preparation cannot be compared with what operates in other professions like medicine, law, engineering etc.
- ❖ There is lack of self-confidence and dignity of labour on the part of many teachers.
- ❖ The effects of teachers are not felt immediately on like other professionals such as doctors.

UNIT 4: THE TEACHING PROCESS

At the end of this unit the students should be able to:

- (1) Explain the meaning of teaching
- (2) Explain the nature of teaching the act of teaching, teaching as an enterprise teaching as an occupation, and
- (3) List and explain other activities which resemble teaching.

The Concept of Teaching:

Teaching is a central activity in the field of education and a key factor in national development. It is through teaching that knowledge, skills, values, and attitudes are transmitted from one generation to another. In modern educational practice, teaching is no longer seen as merely the transfer of knowledge but as a facilitative and interactive process that promotes meaningful learning.

The teaching process involves a deliberate effort by the teacher to create conditions that will enable learners to learn effectively. It includes planning, implementation, classroom interaction, and evaluation. Effective teaching requires a deep understanding of subject matter, pedagogy, learner characteristics, and the learning environment.

This lecture explores the concept, nature, and dimensions of teaching, including teaching as an act, enterprise, and occupation. It also distinguishes teaching from related activities such as instruction, conditioning, indoctrination, training, and drilling.

Teaching is a complex concept that has been defined differently by scholars, depending on their perspectives.

Definitions of Teaching

- ✓ Teaching is the process of imparting knowledge, skills, attitudes, and values to learners.
- ✓ It is a planned activity aimed at bringing about desirable changes in learners' behaviour.
- ✓ Teaching can also be defined as the art and science of helping others to learn.

According to educational theorists, teaching involves:

- ❖ Guiding learners
- ❖ Facilitating understanding
- ❖ Encouraging active participation
- ❖ Assessing learning outcomes.

Teaching cannot occur in isolation. It involves several essential components:

The Teacher: The teacher is the facilitator, guide, and motivator. A good teacher possesses subject mastery and pedagogical skills.

The Learner: Learners are active participants in the teaching-learning process. Their needs, abilities, and interests must be considered.

The Content: This refers to the subject matter or curriculum to be taught.

Teaching Methods: These are strategies used by the teacher to deliver content (e.g., lecture, discussion, demonstration).

Learning Environment: The physical and psychological setting where teaching occurs.

Evaluation: The process of assessing whether learning objectives have been achieved.

Characteristics of Teaching

- ❖ Goal-oriented: Teaching aims at achieving specific objectives
- ❖ Interactive: It involves communication between teacher and learners
- ❖ Dynamic: It adapts to changes in society and learner needs
- ❖ Continuous: Teaching and learning occur throughout life
- ❖ Intentional: It is deliberate and planned

Teaching can be defined as the work we do and by means of which we earn our living. It can also be defined as a cluster of activities that we engage in during some specific time period. It may be defined as an act of a particular kind.

The Nature of Teaching

Teaching is a conscious and deliberate effort made by a mature or experienced person (referred to as the teacher) to impart knowledge to an immature or less experienced person (referred to as the learner). The purpose of teaching is to impart learning.

Teaching can be viewed in three perspectives - that is as an Act, as an Enterprise, and as an Occupation.

Teaching as an Act: This is also referred to as teaching as an exercise. It is the very activity of Teaching, i.e., the process of passing information, knowledge, attitude and skills to the learners. It is complex and consists of a number of activities. For example a teacher

going round the class checking students' notes, marking assignment, writing on the board, listening to students' reading, watching students carry out group project etc. It involves body movement or movement of parts of the body. The act of teaching is a system of actions intended to induce learning. The act of teaching is done through morally acceptable methods. Teaching as an act involves:

- ✓ A person who is consciously and deliberately doing the teaching;
- ✓ Another person or oneself who is being taught;
- ✓ Some contents or material information, knowledge and so on that is being imparted;
- ✓ Finally, an intention on the part of the person doing the act that the recipient should learn.

Teaching as an Enterprise: It refers to other activities that teachers engage in beside teaching contents. Although what the teacher is employed to do is teaching. In a school, a teacher engages in a number of activities besides the teaching act. For example, marking register, maintaining discipline, filling the record book, conducting assembly, supervising labour, etc. Teaching as an enterprise involves a cluster of activities that have the teaching act at its centre. It facilitates the teaching act and contributes towards the total education of the learners committed to the teacher's charge. Teaching as an enterprise therefore supports the development of a wide range of work and professional skills and capabilities.

Teaching as an occupation: Teaching is regarded as an occupation if it is what one does to earn a living. The following criteria are what make teaching a profession,

1. A fairly long period of formal training
2. A body of specialised knowledge and skills
3. A procedure for certification or validation of membership in the profession
4. A set of standard of performance (intellectual practical and ethics) which are defined and enforced by members of the profession.
5. Attachment or commitment to the profession with a willingness to advance its growth and effectiveness.
6. A bond of association between those who are in the profession.
7. A regulated scheme of payment and reward for services rendered.
8. A great regard for the interest or advantage of the client.

Other Activities which Resembles Teaching:

1. **Instruction:** This involves a one-sided activity in which instruction is passed from a superior person to a passive recipient. There is no mutual participation or dialogue. Instruction is from a superior to a less superior person e.g. mother to child. It is a one-sided activity.

2. **Conditioning:** It involves the use of force or threat or some other form of inducement to make a learner perform some action contrary to his wishes. Conditioning refers mostly to performance of action or acquisition of habits by means of force or inducement on the learners. The consent of the learner is not sought. Conditioning has no regards for the learner or his integrity. It does not require his understanding or intelligence in what is being learnt; and generally it is in the interest of the conditioner rather than the victim.

3. **Indoctrinating:** It is concerned with making a person accept certain types of beliefs in a way that shuts off the learners' ability or freedom to ask question or make doubt about it. Indoctrination is a systematic process of promoting a particular ideology or belief system to individuals or groups in a way that suppresses critical thinking.

It has the following characteristics:

- ✓ It presents dogmatic teaching.
 - ✓ Limited information
 - ✓ It involves emotional manipulation
 - ✓ There is forced compliance
 - ✓ No questioning
 - ✓ There is lack of objective evaluation
 - ✓ It is one-sided
- a. It involves inculcating beliefs which are controversial as though they are absolute true and not open to doubt. Such belief may be political ideology religious or economic doctrines
 - b. The method is that of propagating or presentation of a one-sided view of things
 - c. It holds on to beliefs, dogmas and doctrines that are unshakable and does not entertain any contradictions.

4. **Training:** This is a planned and systematic sequence of instruction under competent supervision and it is designed to impart predetermined skills, knowledge or abilities with

respect to designated occupation objectives. Training aims at successful performance of limited abilities or skills. Although, training may involve extensive use of understanding for successful performance. Its focus is specific and narrow. It focuses on development of skills.

5. **Drilling:** This is the repetition of a piece of learning until one can recite or perform it without mistakes. It is the formation of habits through regular practice of stereotyped exercises. Drill may be part of teaching but different from it in that it is excessively narrow in aims and contents. Drilling does not require much understanding or intelligence from the person being drilled.

Teaching Processes

Teaching can be reduced to preparation, presentation, application and review and evaluation.

Preparation: For each lesson or instructional period the instructor must prepare a lesson plan. Traditionally this plan includes a statement of lesson objectives, the procedures and facilities to be used during the lesson, the specific goals to be attained and the means to be used for review and evaluation. The lesson plan should also include home study or other special preparation to be done by the student. The instructor should make certain that all necessary supplies, materials and equipment needed for the lessons are readily available and that the equipment is operating properly.

Preparation of the lesson plan may be accomplished after reference to the syllabus or practical test standards (PTS) or it may be in pre-printed form as prepared by a publisher of training materials. These documents will list general objectives that are to be accomplished. Objectives are needed to bring the unit of instruction into focus. The instructor can organize the overall instructional plan by writing down the objectives and making certain that they flow in a logical sequence from beginning to end. The objectives

allow the instructor to structure the training and permit the student to clearly see what is required along the way. It also allows persons outside the process to see and evaluate what is supposed to take place.

Presentation: Instructors have several methods of presentation from which to choose. The nature of the subject matter and the objectives in teaching it normally determine the method of presentation.

Application: This is where the student uses what the instructor has presented. After a classroom presentation, the student may be asked to explain the new material. The student also may be asked to perform a procedure or operation that has just been demonstrated. In most instructional situations, the instructor's explanation and demonstration activities are alternated with student performance efforts. The instructor makes a presentation and then asks the student to try the same procedure or operation.

Review and Evaluation: Before the end of the instructional period the instructor should review what has been covered during the lesson and require the students to demonstrate how well the lesson objectives have been met.

The evaluation of students' performance and accomplishment during a lesson should be based on the objectives and goals that were established in the instructor's lesson plan. Review and evaluation in every lesson provides opportunities for both positive feedback and correction of faults.

Practice Questions

- i. Give a brief and explicit meaning of (a) Profession (b) Teaching
- ii. Identify five characteristics that qualify teaching as a profession.
- iii. Highlight the various categories of people found in teaching.
- iv. Discuss teaching as a profession in Nigeria.
- v. List and explain the various processes of teaching.

UNIT 5: THE LEARNER AND LEARNING PROCESS

A. UNDERSTANDING LEARNERS

Types of learners

Since students are at the centre of teaching and learning processes, there is need for teachers to identify the different types of learners so as to be able to prepare suitable instructional materials to cater for their varying learning needs. The types of learners include

- ❖ Slow learners
- ❖ Gifted and talented learners
- ❖ Normal or average learners
- ❖ Learners with disabilities.

How to identify different types of learners

- ❖ Through interviews
- ❖ Special dialogues with parents
- ❖ Teachers' daily observation in and outside the class

Helps teachers can render to the types of learners

- ❖ Teachers should structure their teaching to students' abilities.
- ❖ Teachers should build upon previous experiences of the learners.
- ❖ Teachers should create conducive environment for learning to take place.
- ❖ Teachers can organize special classes to help slow learners catch up with others.
- ❖ Teachers should be systematic and patient, and use concrete items (instructional materials) when teaching slow learners.
- ❖ Slow learners should be given special reinforcement.
- ❖ The gifted and talented should be given leadership roles to play.
- ❖ The gifted and talented should be given more work loads.

TYPES OF LEARNERS

a. NORMAL OR AVERAGE LEARNERS

Majority of learners can be classified as normal learners because they have average abilities.

Characteristics of normal learners

- ❖ They manifest average abilities
- ❖ They have their own learning problems like lateness to school, truancy, wrong peer group etc.
- ❖ They manifest giftedness when faced with challenges

b. LEARNERS WITH DISABILITIES

- ❖ This category of learners has various physical impairments such as learning impairment, eye impairment, speech impairment, walking impairment etc. for this reason, special equipment may be necessary to facilitate their learning and movement such as wheel chair, braille books, tape recorders etc.
- ❖ Learners with disabilities can be gifted, normal or slow learners.

Characteristics of learners with disabilities

- ❖ They have physical deformities that people can see
- ❖ They have sound intellectual abilities
- ❖ Some of them are gifted/talented
- ❖ They have feelings of inadequately
- ❖ They have feelings of low self-concept (inferiority Complex)

c. GIFTED AND TALENTED LEARNERS

These refer to learners who have exceptional and outstanding intellectual ability.

Characteristics of Gifted and Talented Learners

- ❖ They rank high in academic achievement.
- ❖ They can cover a wide ground within a short period of time
- ❖ They are fast thinking, highly creative and imaginative with very high constructive ability.
- ❖ They have very good cordial relationship
- ❖ They make friends easily
- ❖ They have outstanding leadership qualities
- ❖ They can work well under pressure
- ❖ They are invariably good in all subjects- science, art, etc.

SLOW LEARNERS

Slow learners refer to the category of students who lag behind in virtually all that they do and especially in their school work. They exhibit numerous learning difficulties that seem to defy all learning methodologies and procedures. They are made up of mentally retarded and the learning disabled (LD). They are also called backward learners.

Characteristics of Slow Learners

- ❖ They have short attention span
- ❖ They have short memory
- ❖ They have no interest in learning
- ❖ They have poor communication skills
- ❖ They have poor eye-hand coordination
- ❖ They are very poor in calculations
- ❖ They have poor social interaction

Causes of slow learning among learners

- ❖ ***Health problem:*** Mother contracting measles, venereal diseases, malnutrition during pregnancy.
- ❖ ***Genetic problem:*** It is possible that this characteristic of slow learning must be in the family line of the learners
- ❖ ***Psychological problems:*** Mothers who experienced intense and excessive anxiety, worry, stress and such like during pregnancy may give birth to disturbed children
- ❖ ***Home based problems:*** Broken homes and extreme poverty of parents may affect the child.
- ❖ ***School based problem*** such as poor methods of teaching, poor teaching and poor learning environment may result in slow learning among learners.

UNIT 5B: THE LEARNING PROCESS

What is learning?

- ❖ Learning is a change in response or behaviour such as innovation, elimination or modification of response involving some certain degree of performance caused partially or wholly by experience.
- ❖ Learning is a relatively more or less permanent change in behaviour which comes about as a result of practice
- ❖ Learning occurs when the activity of an organism brings about a relatively permanent change in its behaviour.
- ❖ Learning is the ability to benefit from experience

All the above definitions emphasized three basic elements in the learning process

- The learner
- The materials to be learned
- The learning technique or methods of teaching/learning

The key words in the definitions include

- Relative permanence of behaviour
- The changed behaviour
- Experience or practice

The learning Experience

This is the learning experience itself that learner is meant to undergo. it takes the form of acquisition and modification of skill, knowledge or attitude

The changed behaviour: it is a new awareness and as such a new experience to the learner.

Change in behaviour

For learning to have taken place after an exposure to the learning experience, there must be a change in the learners behaviour, the change in behaviour must lead to better functioning in the learner.

Performance of the changed behaviour

From the definition of learning, for the change in the behaviour of the learner to be referred to as learning, it must be part and parcel of the learners' behaviour.

Principles of learning

The principles of learning are basic guidelines that explain how people acquire, retain, and apply knowledge or skills. Different psychologists have proposed slightly different lists, but the most widely accepted principles (largely from educational psychology and behaviorism) include:

1. **Readiness:** Learning happens best when a person is physically and mentally prepared. If a learner is not ready, learning becomes ineffective or frustrating.
2. **Exercise (Practice):** The more a skill or knowledge is practiced, the stronger it becomes. “Use it or lose it” applies here. Repetition strengthens memory and understanding.
3. **Effect:** Learning is strengthened when it is followed by satisfaction or reward, and weakened when followed by discomfort or punishment.
4. **Primacy:** What is learned first creates a strong impression. First experiences are often remembered longer and more clearly.
5. **Recency:** The most recent information learned is easier to recall. This is why revision right before exams can help.
6. **Intensity:** Learning is stronger when the experience is vivid, interesting, or engaging.
7. **Freedom:** People learn better when they feel free to explore and participate without excessive pressure.
8. **Motivation:** Motivation drives learning. Can be intrinsic (interest, curiosity) or extrinsic (rewards, grades).
9. **Reinforcement:** Positive reinforcement (rewards, praise) strengthens learning, while negative reinforcement may discourage behavior.
10. **Feedback:** Learners improve faster when they receive clear feedback about their performance.

Factors that affect learning

Several factors affect learning among children. Some of these factors include: Motivation, maturation, readiness, environmental factors (home & school environment), interest, attention, peer group influence among others. They are discussed as follows:

1. **Motivation:** If a child is not properly motivated either intrinsically or extrinsically, learning may be affected.
2. **Maturation and readiness:** There is need for an individual to be matured before he can be said to be ready for learning. For example, a six months old child cannot be said to be matured and ready to learn how to read and write.
3. **Psychological disposition of the child:** A child that is psychologically imbalanced may not be able to learn. A child that is bereaved, involved in an accident or that has just experienced some unpleasant experiences may not be psychologically balanced to learn.
4. **Previously Acquired Habits:** Habits can be defined as an involuntary tendency on the part of a human being to act constantly in a certain way. It is an outcome of repetitive acts. Habits that an individual has acquired in the past may pose as hindrance to his ability to learn in a new situation.
5. **Health of the learner:** It is only a healthy child that will be able to learn properly. A sickle-cell child will not be able to concentrate or be at alert to learn.
6. **Teacher Factor:** Teachers to a great extent can either influence learning either positively or negatively. A teacher that uses negative or abusive languages on learners will not encourage such learners to learn and vice versa. Also, the ability of the teacher to manage his or her class properly can help improve learning among learners.
7. **Disability or Physical Condition:** Learners with any form of impairment or disability such as eye, hearing, speaking and so on may not be able to learn as expected.
8. **Individual differences among learners:** The fact that there are individual differences existing among learners is a factor that affects learning. Some have high intelligence quotient (IQ), wealthy parents, friendly environment, etc. while others do not.

9. **Peer group Influence:** This factor also affects learners' ability to learn especially when peers do not approve of their friends involvement in learning activities.
10. **Environmental factors that affect learners:** The environment of a child to a great extent affects his/her ability to learn or not. The learners' environment can be classified as:
- a) **Home Environment:** If the home environment of a learner is not conducive for learning activities, the learner will find it difficult to learn.
 - ◆ In a situation where parents are always fighting it will affect the child psychologically and the child can find it difficult to learn with concentration.
 - ◆ Encouragement from parents also affects learning.
 - ◆ In a situation when parents do not get involved in their children's learning activities, the learning ability of the learners is affected.
 - ◆ The socio-economic status of the learners' parents also goes a long way in affecting learning, where parents are for example, poor. It will be difficult to meet the needs of the learners.
 - b) **School Environment:** The location where a school is situated is a factor that affects learning. If a school is sited or located close to a market environment, students' learning may be influenced negatively.
 - c) **Classroom Environment:** The classroom conditions also constitute factors that can either impede or enhance learning. A well ventilated classroom, well illuminated, and well-arranged classroom can help to facilitate learning.

HOW CHILDREN LEARN

- ❖ Children learn more when teaching appeals to their senses i.e. when they can see, feel, taste, touch and/or smell something being taught to them.
- ❖ Children learn when they can handle concrete objects rather than abstract ideas. Hence, the importance of teaching aids in teaching.

- ❖ Children learn when you punctuate oral lessons with short periods or activities e.g. writing, drawing etc.
- ❖ Children learn through repetition. Thus teachers need to ask question from time to time to ensure that the children are learning.
- ❖ Children learn by paying attention, being alert, listening and asking questions. It is therefore important for teachers to take note of how students learn and facilitate their learning.
- ❖ Children learn best when correct behavior is reinforced. Teachers should always provide reinforcement or reward for the desirable behavior.
- ❖ Children learn best when thinking is stimulated. Thinking is the recalling and using of facts. Reflective thinking occurs only where there is a challenge.
- ❖ Children learn best when there is interest. Interest is a personal dynamic quality that motivates us to spend more time and effort on what we find desirable.

UNIT 6: HISTORY OF EDUCATION IN NIGERIA

Introduction

Education in Nigeria has evolved through different historical stages, beginning from indigenous systems of learning to the modern formal educational structure. Each stage reflected the social, cultural, religious, political, and economic realities of the society at that time. The history of education in Nigeria can therefore be studied under the following major phases:

- Traditional Education
- Islamic Education
- Christian Missionary Education
- Modern (Western) Education
- Post-Colonial Education System
- Educational Policies and Reforms (6-3-3-4 and 9-3-4 systems)

(A) TRADITIONAL EDUCATION IN NIGERIA

Meaning of Traditional Education

Traditional education refers to the indigenous system of education that existed in Nigeria before the introduction of Islamic and Western education. It was informal, practical, and community-based.

The primary aim was to prepare individuals for responsible living within their communities.

Characteristics of Traditional Education

Informal Nature: Education was not classroom-based but took place in homes, farms, markets, and community gatherings.

Functional Education: Learning focused on practical skills needed for survival.

Community Participation: Parents, elders, and craftsmen participated in the training of children.

Moral Instruction: Emphasis was placed on honesty, discipline, respect, and obedience.

Vocational Orientation: Learners acquired occupational skills such as farming, fishing, hunting, weaving, blacksmithing, and trading.

Oral Transmission: Knowledge was passed through storytelling, songs, proverbs, folktales, and observation.

Objectives of Traditional Education

- 1) To preserve cultural heritage
- 2) To develop character and morality
- 3) To prepare children for adulthood
- 4) To promote social responsibility
- 5) To ensure economic self-reliance
- 6) To maintain unity and social order

Methods of Traditional Education

- 1) Observation
- 2) Imitation
- 3) Participation
- 4) Apprenticeship
- 5) Storytelling
- 6) Demonstration

Merits of Traditional Education

- 1) Promoted practical skills
- 2) Encouraged respect for elders
- 3) Preserved cultural values
- 4) Fostered communal living
- 5) Produced self-reliant individuals

Demerits of Traditional Education

- 1) Lack of scientific knowledge
- 2) Absence of formal certification
- 3) Limited scope of learning
- 4) Resistance to modernization
- 5) Poor documentation of knowledge

(B) ISLAMIC EDUCATION IN NIGERIA

Islamic education came into Nigeria through trans-Saharan trade and Islamic scholars, especially in the northern part of the country around the 11th century.

Islamic education became prominent in Kanem-Borno and the Hausa states.

Objectives of Islamic Education

- 1) To teach the Quran and Islamic principles
- 2) To promote moral discipline
- 3) To spread Islam
- 4) To train Islamic scholars and judges
- 5) To develop literacy in Arabic language

Features of Islamic Education

- 1) Quranic schools were common.
- 2) Arabic was the language of instruction.
- 3) Emphasis was placed on religious instruction.
- 4) Memorization was widely used.
- 5) Teachers were highly respected.

Curriculum of Islamic Education

- Quran recitation
- Arabic language
- Hadith
- Islamic law
- Theology
- Arithmetic
- Writing

Contributions of Islamic Education

- 1) Promotion of literacy
- 2) Development of scholarship
- 3) Introduction of written records
- 4) Promotion of discipline and morality
- 5) Development of administration in Northern Nigeria

Limitations of Islamic Education

- 1) Overemphasis on religion
- 2) Limited scientific and technical education
- 3) Gender inequality in some areas
- 4) Resistance to Western education initially

(C) CHRISTIAN MISSIONARY EDUCATION

Introduction

Christian missionary education began in Nigeria in the 19th century through the activities of Christian missionaries from Europe.

The missionaries established schools mainly to spread Christianity.

Major missionary groups included:

- Church Missionary Society
- Wesleyan Methodist Missionary Society
- Roman Catholic Mission
- Baptist Mission

Objectives of Missionary Education

- 1) To spread Christianity
- 2) To train catechists and church workers
- 3) To promote literacy
- 4) To develop moral character
- 5) To produce interpreters and clerks

Features of Missionary Education

- 1) Establishment of formal schools
- 2) Introduction of reading and writing
- 3) Use of English language
- 4) Religious instruction as a core subject
- 5) Introduction of examinations and certificates
- 6) Contributions of Missionary Education
- 7) Introduction of formal education
- 8) Development of literacy
- 9) Production of educated elites
- 10) Introduction of teacher education
- 11) Development of printing and publishing
- 12) Promotion of girls' education

Problems of Missionary Education

- 1) Regional imbalance in education
- 2) Denominational rivalry
- 3) Neglect of indigenous culture
- 4) Limited technical education
- 5) Overemphasis on religion

(D) MODERN (WESTERN) EDUCATION IN NIGERIA

Modern or Western education refers to the formal educational system introduced by Europeans and later regulated by the colonial government.

It involves structured curriculum, classrooms, examinations, and certification.

Development of Western Education in Nigeria

Early Phase

The first primary school in Nigeria was established in Badagry in 1843 by Christian missionaries.

Colonial Government Involvement

Initially, the colonial government showed little interest in education. Later, it became involved through educational ordinances and grants.

Important educational ordinances were enacted in: 1882, 1887, 1916, 1926, and 1948.

Features of Western Education

- 1) Formal curriculum
- 2) Classroom teaching
- 3) Examination system
- 4) Certification
- 5) Specialized subjects
- 6) Teacher training institutions

Advantages of Western Education

- 1) Development of manpower
- 2) Scientific and technological advancement
- 3) National development
- 4) International communication
- 5) Professional specialization

Disadvantages of Western Education

- 1) Neglect of indigenous culture
- 2) White-collar job mentality
- 3) Urban migration
- 4) Examination malpractice
- 5) Unemployment among graduates

(E) POST-COLONIAL EDUCATION SYSTEM

After Nigeria gained independence in 1960, efforts were made to reform the educational system to suit national needs and aspirations.

Educational reforms focused on:

- 1) National unity
- 2) Economic development
- 3) Technological advancement
- 4) Equal educational opportunities

THE PHELPS-STOKES COMMISSION

The Phelps-Stokes Commission was sponsored by the Phelps-Stokes Fund in the 1920s to examine education in Africa.

The commission visited West Africa, including Nigeria.

Recommendations of the Commission

- 1) Education should relate to African needs.
- 2) Emphasis should be placed on vocational and agricultural education.
- 3) Teacher training should be improved.
- 4) Local languages should be encouraged.
- 5) Government should participate actively in education.

Significance

- 1) Influenced the 1926 Education Ordinance
- 2) Encouraged practical education
- 3) Improved teacher education

THE ASHBY COMMISSION

The Ashby Commission was established in 1959 by the Nigerian government under Sir Eric Ashby.

Its major task was to investigate Nigeria's needs in higher education.

Objectives of the Commission

- 1) To determine manpower needs
- 2) To recommend higher education expansion
- 3) To advise on university development

Recommendations

- 1) Establishment of more universities
- 2) Expansion of teacher training
- 3) Development of technical education
- 4) Increase in university funding
- 5) Award of scholarships

Achievements

The commission led to the establishment of universities such as: University of Lagos, Ahmadu Bello University, and University of Nigeria.

THE ELLIOT COMMISSION

The Elliot Commission was set up in 1943 by the British Colonial Government to examine higher education in West Africa.

Two reports emerged:

- The Majority Report
- The Minority Report

Recommendations

- 1) Establishment of universities in West Africa
- 2) Affiliation with British universities
- 3) Improvement in higher education standards

Significance in Nigeria

The commission contributed to the establishment of University College Ibadan in 1948.

(F) THE 6-3-3-4 EDUCATIONAL SYSTEM

The 6-3-3-4 system was introduced in 1982 following the National Policy on Education.

It consisted of:

- 1) 6 years of Primary Education
- 2) 3 years of Junior Secondary Education
- 3) 3 years of Senior Secondary Education
- 4) 4 years of University Education

Objectives

- 1) Functional education
- 2) Vocational and technical training
- 3) Self-reliance
- 4) Preparation for employment

Features

Primary Education (6 Years) - which involved Basic literacy and numeracy.

Junior Secondary (3 Years) which involved pre-vocational and academic subjects.

Senior Secondary (3 Years) which involved subjects specialization in Science, arts, and commercial specialization.

Tertiary Education (4 Years) which involved professional and advanced learning.

Merits

- 1) Encouraged vocational education
- 2) Reduced dropout rates
- 3) Promoted diversified curriculum

Problems

- 1) Poor funding
- 2) Inadequate facilities
- 3) Shortage of qualified teachers
- 4) Poor implementation

THE 9-3-4 EDUCATIONAL SYSTEM

The 9-3-4 system replaced the 6-3-3-4 structure after the introduction of Universal Basic Education (UBE). It includes:

- 9 years of Basic Education
- 3 years of Senior Secondary Education
- 4 years of Tertiary Education

Components of the 9-Year Basic Education

- Lower Basic (Primary 1–3)
- Middle Basic (Primary 4–6)
- Upper Basic (JSS 1–3)

Objectives

- 1) Universal access to education
- 2) Reduction of illiteracy
- 3) Promotion of lifelong learning
- 4) Skill acquisition and entrepreneurship

Advantages

- 1) Free and compulsory basic education
- 2) Reduction in school dropout
- 3) Promotion of national development

Challenges

- 1) Inadequate infrastructure
- 2) Insufficient funding
- 3) Overcrowded classrooms
- 4) Poor monitoring and supervision

Conclusion

The history of education in Nigeria reflects the country's cultural, religious, and political transformations. From traditional indigenous education to modern educational reforms, each phase contributed significantly to national development. Despite numerous challenges, Nigeria's educational system continues to evolve in response to societal needs, globalization, and technological advancement.

UNIT 7: NATIONAL POLICY ON EDUCATION IN NIGERIA

Introduction

The National Policy on Education (NPE) in Nigeria is the official government document that guides the administration, structure, and delivery of education at all levels. First introduced in 1977 and revised several times (most recently by the Federal Republic of Nigeria), the policy reflects Nigeria's aspirations for national development, unity, and self-reliance through education.

The policy serves as the foundation for educational planning, curriculum development, and implementation across the country.

(a) Philosophy and Goals of Education in Nigeria

Philosophy of Education in Nigeria

The philosophy of Nigerian education is rooted in the belief that education is an instrument for national development. It is designed to reflect the nation's needs, culture, and aspirations.

Core Philosophical Principles

- ❖ Education as a tool for national unity and integration
- ❖ Promotion of individual and societal development
- ❖ Development of self-reliant citizens
- ❖ Respect for dignity of labour
- ❖ Equality of educational opportunities

National Goals of Education

The goals of education in Nigeria are derived from the broader national goals, which include:

- ❖ Building a free and democratic society
- ❖ Establishing a just and egalitarian society
- ❖ Building a united, strong, and self-reliant nation
- ❖ Developing a great and dynamic economy
- ❖ Providing equal opportunities for all citizens

Specific Objectives of Nigerian Education

- ❖ Inculcation of national consciousness and unity
- ❖ Development of appropriate skills, values, and competencies
- ❖ Training of the mind for understanding the world
- ❖ Acquisition of both physical and intellectual skills

Importance of the Philosophy and Goals

- ❖ Guides curriculum development
- ❖ Shapes educational policies and reforms
- ❖ Promotes national identity and cohesion
- ❖ Encourages innovation and productivity

(b) The Universal Basic Education (UBE)

Concept of UBE

The Universal Basic Education (UBE) is a reform programme introduced in 1999 to provide free, compulsory, and universal basic education for every Nigerian child.

It expands the earlier Universal Primary Education (UPE) to include junior secondary education.

Structure of UBE

- ❖ 6 years of Primary Education
- ❖ 3 years of Junior Secondary Education
- ❖ Total: 9 years of continuous schooling

Objectives of UBE

- ❖ Ensure access to education for all children
- ❖ Reduce dropout rates
- ❖ Improve literacy and numeracy
- ❖ Provide life skills and values
- ❖ Promote national integration

Key Components of UBE

- a. Formal Basic Education: For children aged 6–15
- b. Non-Formal Education: For out-of-school youths and adults
- c. Special Programmes

- ❖ Nomadic education
- ❖ Almajiri education
- ❖ Education for people with disabilities

Implementation Strategies

- ❖ Establishment of UBE Commission
- ❖ Teacher training and recruitment
- ❖ Provision of instructional materials
- ❖ School infrastructure development

Achievements of UBE

- ❖ Increased school enrolment
- ❖ Greater awareness of the importance of education
- ❖ Expansion of educational facilities
- ❖ Reduction in illiteracy levels (though still ongoing)

(c) Challenges of Implementing the UBE

Despite its noble objectives, the UBE programme faces several challenges:

1. Inadequate Funding
 - ❖ Insufficient budget allocation
 - ❖ Poor financial management
2. Poor Infrastructure
 - ❖ Overcrowded classrooms
 - ❖ Dilapidated school buildings
 - ❖ Lack of teaching materials
3. Teacher-Related Issues
 - ❖ Shortage of qualified teachers
 - ❖ Poor remuneration
 - ❖ Lack of motivation
4. High Dropout Rates
 - ❖ Poverty
 - ❖ Child labour
 - ❖ Cultural and religious factors
5. Administrative Problems
 - ❖ Weak supervision and monitoring
 - ❖ Corruption and mismanagement
6. Regional Disparities: Educational imbalance between Northern and Southern Nigeria
7. Insecurity: Insurgency and kidnapping affecting school attendance

Solutions to UBE Challenges

- ❖ Increased government funding
- ❖ Teacher training and incentives
- ❖ Community participation
- ❖ Improved monitoring and evaluation
- ❖ Use of technology in education

(d) Post-Basic Education

Post-Basic Education refers to education received after the 9-year basic education, mainly at the Senior Secondary School (SSS) level.

Rationale of Post-Basic Education

The rationale includes:

- ❖ Preparation for higher education
- ❖ Development of specialized skills
- ❖ Preparation for the labour market
- ❖ Reduction of unemployment
- ❖ Promotion of entrepreneurship

Structure of Post-Basic Education

This consists of 3 years of Senior Secondary Education followed by Tertiary education (universities, polytechnics, colleges of education).

Curriculum Focus: The curriculum is diversified to meet students' interests and national needs.

Subject Offerings and Streaming

Students are grouped into streams based on interests and abilities:

1. Science Stream

Subjects include:

- ❖ Physics
- ❖ Chemistry
- ❖ Biology
- ❖ Mathematics

2. Arts/Humanities Stream

Subjects include:

- ❖ Government
- ❖ Literature in English
- ❖ History
- ❖ CRS/IRS

3. Commercial Stream

Subjects include:

- ❖ Accounting
- ❖ Commerce
- ❖ Economics
- ❖ Office Practice

4. Technical/Vocational Stream

Subjects include:

- ❖ Technical drawing
- ❖ Woodwork
- ❖ Metalwork
- ❖ ICT

Importance of Subject Streaming

- ❖ Encourages specialization
- ❖ Develops talents and interests
- ❖ Prepares students for careers
- ❖ Enhances productivity

Challenges of Implementing Post-Basic Education

1. Inadequate Facilities such as lack of laboratories and workshops and poor learning environment.
2. Shortage of Qualified Teachers especially in science and technical subjects
3. Poor Funding leading to insufficient resources for curriculum implementation
4. Examination Malpractice as this undermines educational standards
5. Overcrowding: High student population in schools
6. Weak Guidance and Counselling. Students often choose wrong career paths
7. Poor Policy Implementation. Gap between policy formulation and execution

Solutions to Post-Basic Education Challenges

- ❖ Provision of adequate infrastructure
- ❖ Recruitment and training of teachers
- ❖ Strengthening guidance and counselling services
- ❖ Increased funding
- ❖ Strict enforcement of discipline and examination ethics

Conclusion

The National Policy on Education remains a vital instrument for Nigeria's development. Through its philosophical foundation, UBE programme, and post-basic education structure, it seeks to produce competent, self-reliant, and responsible citizens.

However, the success of the policy depends largely on effective implementation, adequate funding, and continuous monitoring. Addressing the challenges facing UBE and post-basic education will significantly improve Nigeria's educational system and contribute to national development.

References

- Federal Republic of Nigeria. (2013). National Policy on Education (6th ed.). Abuja: NERDC.
- Universal Basic Education Commission (UBEC). (2015). UBE Programme Implementation Guidelines. Abuja.
- Fafunwa, A. B. (1974). History of Education in Nigeria. London: George Allen & Unwin.
- Taiwo, C. O. (1980). The Nigerian Education System. Lagos: Nelson.
- Obanya, P. (2004). The Dilemma of Education in Africa. Ibadan: Heinemann.

UNIT 8: CHILD AND ADOLESCENT DEVELOPMENT

Introduction

Child and adolescent development is a fundamental area in education and psychology that examines how individuals grow physically, cognitively, socially, and emotionally from birth through adolescence. Understanding these developmental processes helps teachers, parents, and policymakers design appropriate learning experiences and interventions.

Scholars such as Jean Piaget and Erik Erikson have provided frameworks that explain how children and adolescents develop in stages.

(a) Stages of Child Development

Child development is generally categorized into stages, each with unique characteristics.

1. Infancy Stage (0–2 years)

Characteristics

- ❖ Rapid physical growth
- ❖ Development of motor skills (crawling, walking)
- ❖ Beginning of language acquisition
- ❖ Strong attachment to caregivers

Cognitive Development: According to Jean Piaget, this is the sensorimotor stage, where learning occurs through sensory experiences and actions.

Educational Implications

- ❖ Use sensory stimulation (toys, sounds)
- ❖ Provide emotional security
- ❖ Encourage exploration

2. Early Childhood (2–6 years)

Characteristics

- ❖ Rapid language development
- ❖ Curiosity and imagination
- ❖ Egocentric thinking
- ❖ Development of basic social skills

Cognitive Stage: Pre-operational stage (Piaget)

Educational Implications

- ❖ Use play-based learning
- ❖ Encourage creativity
- ❖ Use visual aids and storytelling

3. Middle Childhood (6–11 years)

Characteristics

- ❖ Improved reasoning skills
- ❖ Development of friendships
- ❖ Better emotional control
- ❖ Increased independence

Cognitive Stage: Concrete operational stage

Educational Implications

- ❖ Use practical examples
- ❖ Encourage group work
- ❖ Introduce problem-solving tasks

4. Late Childhood (11–12 years)

- ❖ Transition phase into adolescence
- ❖ Increased self-awareness
- ❖ Beginning of abstract thinking

(b) Factors Affecting Child Development

Child development is influenced by multiple interacting factors:

1. Heredity (Genetics): Determines physical traits and potential abilities
2. Environment: Family, school, and community influence behavior and learning
3. Nutrition: Proper diet enhances brain development. Malnutrition can impair growth and cognition.
4. Socio-Economic Status: Access to resources affects educational opportunities
5. Culture and Beliefs: Shapes values, attitudes, and behaviors
6. Health Conditions: Illnesses can hinder development
7. Education and Stimulation: Quality schooling enhances development

It is noteworthy that development results from the interaction between nature (heredity) and nurture (environment).

(c) Implications of Child Development for Teaching and Learning in the Nigerian School System

Understanding child development has direct implications for effective teaching.

1. Age-Appropriate Teaching: Teachers should match instructional methods with learners' developmental stages.
2. Use of Activity-Based Learning: Especially in primary schools, learning should involve play and participation.
3. Individual Differences: Learners develop at different rates; teaching should be flexible.
4. Classroom Management: Understanding behavior helps manage pupils effectively.
5. Curriculum Design: Curriculum should reflect developmental needs.
6. Language of Instruction: Use simple and clear language appropriate to the child's level.
7. Emotional Support: Teachers must create a supportive and inclusive classroom environment.

Context of Nigerian Schools include large class sizes, limited teaching materials and cultural diversity. There is need for teachers to adapt strategies to these realities.

(d) Stages of Adolescent Development

Adolescence is the period between childhood and adulthood, typically between ages 12–18.

1. Early Adolescence (12–14 years)

Characteristics

- ❖ Puberty begins
- ❖ Emotional instability
- ❖ Desire for independence

2. Middle Adolescence (15–17 years)

Characteristics

- ❖ Increased peer influence
- ❖ Identity exploration
- ❖ Risk-taking behaviors

3. Late Adolescence (18–21 years)

Characteristics

- ❖ Emotional maturity
- ❖ Career focus
- ❖ Independent decision-making

- ❖ Psychosocial Development: According to Erik Erikson, adolescence is marked by the stage of Identity vs. Role Confusion.

Cognitive Development

- ❖ Development of abstract thinking
- ❖ Ability to reason logically
- ❖ Critical thinking skills

(e) Implication of Adolescent Developmental Issues in Education

Adolescents face several developmental challenges that affect education.

1. Identity Crisis: Students struggle with self-identity and this may affect academic focus.
2. Peer Pressure: Influence on behavior (positive or negative)
3. Emotional Instability: Mood swings and conflicts with teachers and parents.
4. Risky Behaviors such as involvement in substance abuse, truancy and the like.
5. Sexual Development Issues such as early relationships and teenage pregnancy.

Educational Implications

1. Guidance and Counselling: Schools must provide counselling services.
2. Moral and Value Education: Promote discipline and responsibility.
3. Teacher-Student Relationship: Teachers should be supportive and understanding.
4. Career Guidance: Help students make informed career choices.

(f) Strategies for Managing Adolescent Behavioral Problems

Managing adolescent behavior requires deliberate strategies:

1. Effective Communication: Listen actively and avoid harsh criticism
2. Guidance and Counselling Services: Professional counselling units in schools
3. Positive Reinforcement: Reward good behavior
4. Parental Involvement: Collaboration between school and home
5. Clear Rules and Discipline: Consistent enforcement of school rules
6. Peer Education Programs: Use peer influence positively
7. Life Skills Education: Teach decision-making and problem-solving
8. Extracurricular Activities: Sports, clubs, and social activities
9. Mentorship Programs: Role models for students
10. Addressing Societal Issues such as reducing poverty and inequality, promoting safe school environments, etc.

Conclusion

Child and adolescent development plays a crucial role in shaping educational outcomes. Teachers who understand developmental stages and challenges are better equipped to deliver effective instruction and manage classrooms.

In Nigeria, addressing the challenges of large class sizes, limited resources, and socio-cultural influences is essential for improving teaching and learning outcomes.

References

- Berk, L. E. (2006). *Child Development*. Boston: Pearson.
- Erik Erikson. (1968). *Identity: Youth and Crisis*.
- Federal Republic of Nigeria (2013). *National Policy on Education*. Abuja: NERDC.
- Jean Piaget. (1952). *The Origins of Intelligence in Children*.
- Santrock, J. W. (2011). *Educational Psychology*. New York: McGraw-Hill.

UNIT 9: LEARNING THEORIES

What Is Learning?

Learning is the process of acquiring new knowledge, skills, behaviors, or attitudes through study, experience, or teaching. It leads to a relatively permanent change in behavior or understanding.

Example: A student learning to solve math problems or ride a bicycle.

Types of Learning

There are several types of learning, but key ones include:

- 1) Classical Conditioning: Learning through association (e.g., Pavlov's dog experiment).
- 2) Operant Conditioning: Learning through rewards and punishments (Skinner's theory).
- 3) Observational Learning: Learning by watching others (Bandura's social learning).
- 4) Cognitive Learning: Involves understanding, problem-solving, and thinking.
- 5) Experiential Learning: Learning through direct experience (e.g., field trips, hands-on activities).
- 6) Constructivist Learning: Learners actively construct their own knowledge based on prior experiences.

Factors Affecting Learning

Several factors influence how well students learn:

1. **Internal (Personal) Factors**
 - a) Interest and motivation
 - b) Intelligence and cognitive ability
 - c) Physical and mental health
2. **External (Environmental) Factors:**
 - a) Quality of teaching
 - b) Classroom environment
 - c) Availability of learning materials
 - d) Family background and support
 - e) Peer influence

Motivating Students to Learn

Teachers and parents can motivate students through:

- **Setting clear goals:** Students perform better when they know what is expected.
- **Providing positive feedback:** Encouragement boosts confidence.
- **Using engaging methods:** Games, group work, and real-life examples help maintain interest.
- **Recognizing effort:** Reward persistence, not just achievement.
- **Creating a supportive environment:** A safe and inclusive setting encourages participation.
- **Linking learning to real life:** Show how learning is useful outside the classroom.

1. BEHAVIOURIST LEARNING THEORY

Behaviourism is a psychological perspective that explains learning as a change in observable behaviour caused by interaction with the environment. It emphasizes stimulus-response (S-R) relationships and views the learner as responding to external stimuli rather than internal mental processes.

Key Principles:

1. Learning as Conditioning: Classical Conditioning (Pavlov): Learning occurs through association (e.g., pairing a stimulus with a response).

Operant Conditioning (Skinner): Learning occurs through reinforcement (rewards) or punishment.

2. Reinforcement and Punishment: Positive reinforcement: Adding something pleasant to increase behaviour (e.g., praise, rewards).

Negative reinforcement: Removing something unpleasant to increase behaviour (e.g., excusing homework if work is done well).

Punishment: Reduces unwanted behaviour (e.g., reprimand, loss of privileges).

3. Observable Behaviour: Behaviour, not mental processes, is the main evidence of learning.

Educational Implications of Behaviourism

Behaviourist principles have shaped classroom teaching and management in several ways:

- 1. Reinforcement in Teaching:** Teachers can use praise, grades, stickers, or tokens to reward desired behaviours (e.g., participation, neat work).
- 2. Drill and Practice:** Repetition and practice are encouraged to strengthen learning (e.g., math drills, language exercises).
- 3. Clear Objectives and Structure:** Learning tasks should be broken down into small, manageable steps with clear instructions.
- 4. Behaviour Modification:** Positive reinforcement can be used to encourage good behaviour, while consistent consequences discourage negative behaviour.
- 5. Programmed Instruction:** Teaching materials are sequenced so students receive immediate feedback (used in computer-assisted learning, quizzes, etc.).
- 6. Classroom Management:** Rules and routines are taught and reinforced, helping to maintain order and discipline.

In summary, Behaviorist learning theory views learning as a change in observable behaviour shaped by reinforcement and punishment. In education, it promotes structured teaching, repetition, immediate feedback, and reward systems to encourage desired learning outcomes.

2. LEARNING THEORISTS AND THEIR CONTRIBUTIONS

1. Ivan Pavlov – Classical Conditioning

Pavlov (1849–1936), a Russian physiologist, is best known for his experiments with dogs that led to the discovery of classical conditioning. He demonstrated that a neutral stimulus (like a bell) could be associated with an unconditioned stimulus (food) to produce a conditioned response (salivation).

Key Idea: Learning occurs through association between stimuli.

Educational Implication: Teachers can create positive classroom environments by associating learning activities with pleasant experiences, thereby motivating students.

2. B. F. Skinner – Operant Conditioning

Skinner (1904–1990), an American psychologist, expanded behaviourism through operant conditioning. He showed that behaviour is shaped and maintained by its consequences. Reinforcement increases desired behaviours, while punishment reduces undesired ones.

Key Idea: Learning is the result of reinforcement and consequences.

Educational Implication: Teachers use rewards (praise, grades, and tokens) to encourage participation and effort, and apply fair consequences to discourage negative behaviours.

3. Edward Thorndike – Connectionism (Trial-and-Error Learning)

Thorndike (1874–1949) proposed the Law of Effect, which states that behaviours followed by satisfying consequences are more likely to be repeated, while those with unpleasant consequences are less likely to recur. His studies on animals led to the concept of trial-and-error learning.

Key Idea: Learning is a gradual process of forming connections between stimulus and response.

Educational Implication: Teachers should provide feedback, practice opportunities, and reinforcement to strengthen correct responses and skills.

4. Robert Gagné – Conditions of Learning

Gagné (1916–2002) developed a comprehensive theory of instruction known as the **Conditions of Learning**. He identified different types of learning outcomes (e.g., verbal information, intellectual skills, motor skills, attitudes, and strategies) and proposed the Nine Events of Instruction, such as gaining attention, presenting content, and providing feedback.

Key Idea: Learning is hierarchical, moving from simple to complex tasks with specific instructional steps.

Educational Implication: Teachers should carefully plan lessons, ensuring prerequisites are mastered before new content, and provide structured instructional support.

Summarily:

- ❖ Pavlov – learning by association (classical conditioning).
- ❖ Skinner – learning through reinforcement (operant conditioning).
- ❖ Thorndike – trial-and-error learning (connectionism, law of effect).
- ❖ Gagné – structured instructional design (conditions of learning).

3. COGNITIVE LEARNING THEORIES

Cognitive learning theories focus on how people think, understand, and remember rather than just how they behave. Unlike behaviourism (which emphasizes stimulus and response), cognitive theories see learning as an active mental process where learners acquire, organize, and store knowledge for later use.

Key Assumptions

1. Learning involves internal mental processes (thinking, memory, perception, problem-solving).
2. Learners are active participants, not passive recipients.
3. Prior knowledge influences how new information is understood and retained.
4. Learning is about building meaningful connections between new ideas and existing knowledge.

Examples of Cognitive Learning Theorists include the following:

- ❖ Jean Piaget – Stages of cognitive development (sensorimotor, preoperational, concrete operational, formal operational).
- ❖ Jerome Bruner – Discovery learning and spiral curriculum.
- ❖ David Ausubel – Meaningful learning and advance organizers.

Educational Implications

1. Active Learning – Students should explore, question, and engage in problem-solving.
2. Use of Prior Knowledge – Teachers should connect new content to learners' existing knowledge.
3. Organized Instruction – Concepts should be presented in structured, logical ways.
4. Scaffolding – Provide support (hints, examples, guidance) and gradually reduce it as learners gain independence.
5. Meaningful Learning – Focus on understanding, not just memorization.

In summary:

Cognitive learning theories explain learning as a mental process of acquiring and organizing knowledge. They stress understanding, memory, and problem-solving, encouraging teaching methods that foster critical thinking and meaningful connections.

COGNITIVE LEARNING THEORISTS:

1. Jean Piaget – Cognitive Development Theory

Jean Piaget (1896–1980), a Swiss psychologist, is known for his stages of cognitive development, which describe how children’s thinking evolves as they grow.

Key Idea: Children actively construct knowledge through interaction with their environment.

Stages:

1. Sensorimotor stage (0–2 years) – learning through senses and actions.
2. Pre-operational stage (2–7 years) – use of symbols, but thinking is egocentric.
3. Concrete Operational stage (7–11 years) – logical thinking about concrete objects.
4. Formal Operational stage (12+ years) – abstract and hypothetical reasoning.

Educational Implication: Teachers should match learning activities to the learner’s developmental stage and encourage active discovery.

2. Jerome Bruner – Discovery Learning & Spiral Curriculum

Jerome Bruner (1915–2016), an American psychologist, emphasized the importance of active involvement in learning.

Key Idea: Learning is best when students discover principles by themselves (discovery learning).

Modes of Representation:

1. **Enactive** – learning through actions.
2. **Iconic** – learning through images and diagrams.
3. **Symbolic** – learning through language and symbols.

Spiral Curriculum: Complex ideas can be taught at any age, provided they are presented in a simplified form and revisited at higher levels.

Educational Implication: Teachers should use problem-solving, inquiry, and hands-on activities, revisiting concepts in increasing depth.

3. David Ausubel – Meaningful Learning Theory

David Ausubel (1918–2008), an American psychologist, focused on how new knowledge connects with existing knowledge.

Key Idea: Meaningful learning happens when new information is related to what the learner already knows, rather than memorized by rote.

Advance Organizers: Tools like outlines, concept maps, or introductory summaries that help learners connect new material with prior knowledge.

Educational Implication: Teachers should activate students' prior knowledge, use organizers, and focus on conceptual understanding rather than rote learning.

In summary:

- ❖ Piaget – Children construct knowledge in developmental stages.
- ❖ Bruner – Learning through discovery, modes of representation, spiral curriculum.
- ❖ Ausubel – Meaningful learning through linking new information with prior knowledge.

5. SOCIO-CULTURAL LEARNING THEORY

Sociocultural learning theory was developed by Lev Vygotsky (1896–1934), a Russian psychologist. The theory emphasizes that learning is a social process and happens first through interaction with others before it is internalized by the individual.

Key Ideas

1. Social Interaction: Learning occurs through dialogue, collaboration, and shared activities with teachers, peers, parents, and the community.

2. Zone of Proximal Development (ZPD): The gap between what a learner can do independently and what they can achieve with guidance. Effective teaching happens in this zone.

3. Scaffolding: Temporary support provided by a more knowledgeable person (teacher, peer, and parent) to help the learner master a task. The support is gradually reduced as the learner becomes more independent.

4. Cultural Tools: Language, symbols, and values of a society shape how individuals think and learn. Language is especially important as a tool of thought and communication.

Educational Implications

- 1) Collaborative Learning: Group work, peer tutoring, and discussions enhance learning.
- 2) Teacher as Facilitator: Teachers guide students within their ZPD, providing scaffolding.
- 3) Cultural Relevance: Teaching should connect with learners' cultural backgrounds and experiences.
- 4) Language Development: Encouraging dialogue, questioning, and explanation foster deeper understanding.

5) **Active Engagement:** Students learn best when they participate in real-life, meaningful activities.

In summary, Sociocultural learning theory sees learning as a socially mediated process where interaction, culture, and language play central roles.

LEV VYGOTSKY (1896–1934) - SOCIO-CULTURAL LEARNING THEORIST

Lev Vygotsky was a Russian psychologist best known for developing the Sociocultural Theory of Learning. He emphasized that cognitive development is largely shaped by social interaction, culture, and language. Unlike Piaget, who focused on stages of individual development, Vygotsky argued that learning is first social before becoming individual.

Key Contributions

1. Zone of Proximal Development (ZPD): The difference between what a learner can do alone and what they can do with guidance. Learning is most effective when instruction targets this zone.

2. Scaffolding: Temporary support provided by a teacher, parent, or peer to help the learner master a task. Support is gradually removed as independence grows.

3. Role of Language: Language is the main tool of thought and communication.

Private speech (self-talk) helps children plan, solve problems, and regulate behaviour.

4. Cultural Influence: Cognitive development is influenced by cultural tools, values, and practices of the learner's environment.

Educational Implications

- 1) Use of collaborative learning (e.g. group discussions, peer tutoring).
- 2) Teachers act as guides and facilitators, not just knowledge transmitters.
- 3) Learning activities should connect with students' cultural background.
- 4) Encourage students to use dialogue and reflection to deepen understanding.

In summary, Vygotsky highlighted the social nature of learning, introducing influential concepts like ZPD and scaffolding, which remain central to modern teaching practices.

UNIT 10: HISTORICAL AND CURRENT DEVELOPMENTS IN PHILOSOPHY OF EDUCATION IN NIGERIA

a. What is Philosophy?

The definition of philosophy is going to be looked at from purely academic perspectives. Philosophy stems from two Greek words- Philo and Sophia.

Philo means love, interest or search while **Sophia** means wisdom or knowledge

Philosophy deals with the acquisition of knowledge. It is a systematic, critical and logical way of acquiring knowledge. It is regarded as a second-order discipline because it is found in every discipline.

Philosophy is a preoccupation with the notion of reality, knowledge and values about which every man is concerned.

John Dewey defined philosophy as the general theory of education.

b. Functions of Philosophy

Philosophy serves several important functions across personal, academic, and societal levels. Here are the main functions of philosophy:

1. **Clarification of Concepts:** Philosophy helps clarify vague or complex ideas, such as justice, truth, beauty, knowledge, and reality. It ensures clear thinking and communication.
2. **Critical Thinking and Analysis:** Philosophy trains individuals to evaluate arguments, identify logical fallacies, and think systematically and independently.
3. **Foundation for Other Disciplines:** Philosophy provides a foundation for other fields such as law, politics, education, science, and ethics. It helps define their assumptions, methods, and goals.
4. **Moral and Ethical Guidance:** Philosophy helps individuals and societies explore ethical questions and make reasoned decisions about right and wrong, justice, and responsibility.
5. **Worldview Formation:** It shapes how people understand the world and their place in it, addressing questions like: Why are we here? What is the nature of reality?

6. Promotes Open-mindedness and Tolerance: Philosophy encourages understanding different perspectives and respecting diverse views, promoting dialogue and peaceful coexistence.

7. Problem-Solving: Philosophical reasoning can be applied to real-life problems by encouraging reflection, long-term thinking, and value-based decision-making.

8. Education and Enlightenment: Philosophy fosters intellectual curiosity and a lifelong love of learning by engaging with deep, timeless questions.

c. The Concept of Education

- 1) Education, according to Dewey (1916), is not only the means through which a culture is transformed.
- 2) Education can also defined as a systematic cultivation of desirable and worthwhile values, knowledge, attitudes and skills into an individual in order to make him or her useful to himself/herself, to others, the society and the world at large.
- 3) Education is also defined as a process of socialization whereby the individual is taught what is desirable in the society.
- 4) Education is an orderly and deliberate effort to transmit or develop knowledge concepts, skills, attitudes, values and habits.
- 5) Education is the process of socialization, enculturation and transmission of what is worthwhile to those who are committed to it, be they children or adults.
- 6) It is a systematic process of acquiring knowledge, desirable attitude, values and skills which enables an individual to be useful to himself in particular and to the society at large.

Whatever constitutes education must involve or affect the domains of learning so that the individuals can be a balanced person (i.e. the cognitive, affective and psychomotor domains).

There must be modification of behavior when talking of acquisition of knowledge.

Bloom's Taxonomy of Educational Objectives

Bloom's taxonomy of educational objectives divides objectives into three main domains which include cognitive, affective and psychomotor.

The Cognitive Domain: The cognitive domain deals with objectives which involve intellectual (mental) abilities.

The cognitive domain is divided into a hierarchy of six intellectual functions from the lowest to the highest. They are as follows:

- ❖ **Knowledge:** This has to do with the recall of previously learnt materials.
- ❖ **Comprehension:** This has to do with the ability to grasp the meaning of learnt materials.
- ❖ **Application:** This has to do with the ability to use learnt materials in new and concrete situations.
- ❖ **Analysis:** It has to do with the ability to breakdown materials into its component parts for better understanding.
- ❖ **Synthesis:** This is concerned with the ability to put parts together to form a new whole.
- ❖ **Evaluation:** it is the ability to make value judgment from materials learnt.

Affective Domain: The affective domain involves objectives which have to do with feelings and emotions such as attitude and appreciation. It is divided into five (5) hierarchical levels from the lowest to the highest.

- ❖ **Receiving:** It is the student's willingness to respond to a given phenomenon e.g. music.
- ❖ **Responding:** It refers to active participation on the part of the student in the given phenomena.
- ❖ **Valuing:** It refers to student's perception on the worth or value of a given phenomenon.
- ❖ **Organization:** It is the ability to bring together different values and resolve conflicts between/ among them.
- ❖ **Characterization:** It has to do with living out a philosophy of life. That is, patterning one's life after a particular philosophy (affective orientation about life).

Psychomotor Domain: This domain is concerned with objectives that emphasis manipulative and motor skills such as handwriting, typing, operating a machine, etc. It is divided into four (4) levels:

- ❖ **Observing:** Observing the performance of a more experienced person.
- ❖ **Imitating**
- ❖ **Practicing:** Repetition of an act or phenomenon.
- ❖ **Adapting:** It refers to perfection of skills.

d. The Concept of Philosophy of Education

What is Philosophy of Education?

It has to do with the application of philosophical ideas, object and tools to educational issues in order to discover problems to education and to provide solutions to the problems in education.

Philosophy of education is the application of philosophical principles or ideas in solving the problems of education.

Relationship between Education and Philosophy

According to Dewey, philosophy and education both deal with the same themes. They both seek to solve the problem of living and both deal with the problems of values, with what is good or bad, and with finding out truths and knowledge in any situation without which an appropriate and effective solution cannot be found.

Thus, philosophy of education is able to critically examine the past, present and make projections into the future with a view to improving standard.

e. Justification/rationale for Philosophy of Education

Why Do We the Study Philosophy of Education?

1. Philosophy when applied to an educational problem will lead to an all-round awareness to all aspects of the problem and philosophical analysis will be employed in arriving at solution to the problem.
2. It provides basic understanding of contexts within which meaningful educational experience can be achieved.

3. It provides the essential ingredients coping with differences encountered (i.e. languages, culture, ideology, etc.).
4. Philosophy helps to make suggestions and recommendations that will fill in the gaps and interpretations that would provide greater coherence in the needed knowledge.
5. To apply philosophical analysis to educational issues in order to find solutions to such educational problem
6. Philosophy of education helps to throw light on the nation and origin of our civilization.
7. To help reduce all forms of indoctrination
8. For an understanding of the aims of education and the nation's educational policies
9. It helps us to understand better the aims of education and the nation's educational policies. This enables us to know the type and nature of the individuals the educational policy intends to produce.
10. To develop our ability to make suggestion for the purpose of educational development.
11. Philosophy enables us to examine philosophic skills critically through the light it throws on educational problems.
12. It helps us to reduce all forms of indoctrination because of the developed minds it creates in an individual.
13. It helps in designing the fundamental curriculum pedagogical methods.
14. It enables the teachers to possess a balanced sense of judgment and better organisation of classroom teaching and learning.

LECTURE NOTES PREPARED BY DR AGNES ANUOLUWAPO ODIA

